

IH07

Mughal Empire and the Marathas

The heaviest single chapter in Indian History - expect 2-3 questions a paper from the medieval block, and most of them land here. Proven repeaters: Sher Shah's monuments and his rupiya (2024), Akbar's Razmnama and the Panch Mahal (2016 and 2023), the Ashtapradhan, the three Panipats and the Anglo-Maratha treaties.

Two centuries of Mughal rule and the Maratha power that broke it. RPSC never asks you to argue about the Mughals - it asks you to date them and to name the officer, the coin, the building, the treaty. Learn this chapter as a set of tables, not as a story.

Mughals and Marathas (1526-1818)

Babur & Humayun

- Panipat I - 21 Apr 1526
- Khanwa 1527 - title Ghazi
- Tuzuk-i-Baburi (Chaghatai Turkish)
- Din Panah; Sher Mandal fall, 1556

Sur interlude 1540-55

- Farid Khan = Sher Shah
- Chausa 1539, Kannauj 1540
- Rupiya 178 grains, dam
- Sasaram tomb; Qila-i-Kuhna 1541
- Sadak-i-Azam (GT Road)

Akbar 1556-1605

- Panipat II - 5 Nov 1556, Hemu
- Ibadat Khana 1575, Mahzar 1579
- Din-i-Ilahi 1582, Sulh-i-Kul
- Fatehpur Sikri 1571, Panch Mahal
- Razmnama = Mahabharata

Administration

- Mansabdari - zat and sawar
- Dahsala/Zabti 1580 - Todar Mal
- 12 subas in 1580 (15 later)
- Diwan, Mir Bakhshi, Mir Saman
- Ain-i-Akbari = vol. 3

Jahangir to Aurangzeb

- Zanjir-i-adl; Nur Jahan's coins
- Dharmat-Samugarh-Khajwa-Deorai
- Jizya reimposed 1679
- Bijapur 1686, Golconda 1687
- Died 1707, buried Khuldabad

The Rajput angle

- Bharmal of Amber, 1562
- Chittor 1568 - Jaimal & Patta
- Haldighati 1576 - Man Singh
- Amar Singh treaty 1615
- Rajput war 1679-81, Durgadas

Decline

- Jagirdari crisis; paibaqi shortage
- Farrukhsiyar's farman 1717
- Karnal 1739 - Nadir Shah
- Peacock Throne & Kohinoor gone

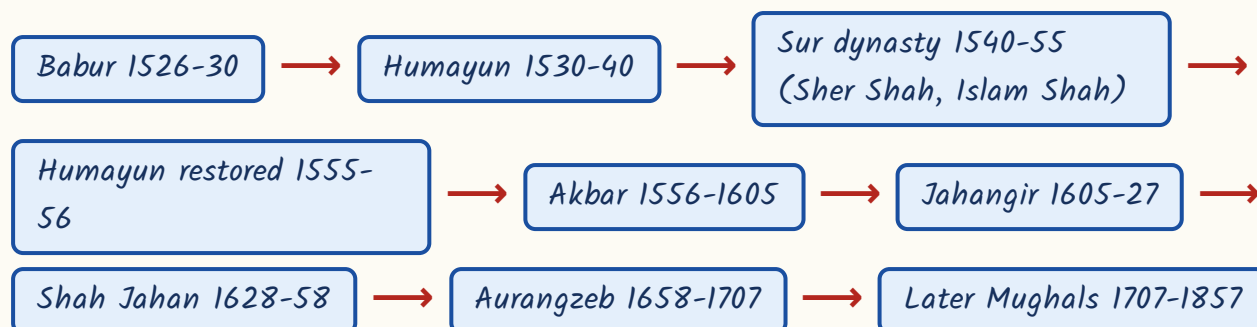
Marathas

- Raigad coronation, 6 June 1674
- Ashtapradhan - eight ministers
- Chauth 1/4, Sardeshmukhi 1/10
- Peshwas hereditary from 1713
- Panipat III - 14 Jan 1761
- Salbai 1782, Bassein 1802

The spine - hold the whole chapter on one line of succession

Before any fact, fix the order of rulers. Almost every trap in this chapter works by moving a fact one emperor up or down the line. Six great Mughals, and an Afghan interruption of fifteen years in the middle. Say the line out loud until it is automatic.

The line of succession - and the Sur break in the middle



- Babur was a Timurid on his father's side and a Chingizid on his mother's - that double descent is why he claimed both Samargand and Delhi.
- Humayun is the only Mughal who lost the empire and won it back; he ruled twice.
- Akbar came to the throne at thirteen; Bairam Khan was regent till 1560.
- Aurangzeb ruled forty-nine years, the longest reign - and the empire was at its largest and weakest by its end.
- Bahadur Shah Zafar was the last, deposed after 1857 and deported to Rangoon.

YAAD RAKHO

Eight date pegs cover half the chapter: 1526 Panipat I, 1556 Panipat II, 1576 Haldighati, 1615 Mewar treaty, 1674 Raigad, 1707 Aurangzeb dies, 1739 Karnal, 1761 Panipat III.

Babur and Humayun - the founding, and the losing of it

Babur did not walk in and take India in one battle. He fought four, in four consecutive years, and each removed a different rival - the Lodis, the Rajputs, a Rajput holdout in Malwa, and finally the Afghans of the east. Learn the four as a run of years: 1526, 1527, 1528, 1529. Then his son lost the whole thing in ten.

- First Battle of Panipat, 21 April 1526 - the first large-scale use of field artillery in India, with the tulughma flanking manoeuvre and the araba cart-and-rope formation.
- Khanwa, 17 March 1527, against Rana Sanga of Mewar - after it Babur declared the war a jihad and took the title Ghazi. That title comes from Khanwa, not Panipat.
- Chanderi 1528 against Medini Rai; Ghaghra 1529 against the Afghans and Nusrat Shah of Bengal.
- Babur's memoir is the Tuzuk-i-Baburi, written in Chaghatai Turkish, his mother tongue; Abdur Rahim Khan-i-Khanan rendered it into Persian as the Baburnama under Akbar.
- Babur died in 1530 at Agra; his body was later moved to Kabul as he had wished.

- Humayun's problem was that he divided the empire among his brothers - Kamran, Askari, Hindal - and then had to fight all three.
- Chausa 1539 and Kannauj (Bilgram) 1540 are two different battles a year apart, both against Humayun. Chausa gave Sher Khan the royal title Sher Shah; Kannauj gave him Delhi and drove Humayun out for fifteen years. Do not merge them.
- In exile he reached Persia; his son Akbar was born at Amarkot in Sindh in 1542, in the house of Rana Prasad.
- Humayun built Din Panah at Delhi, retook Delhi in 1555 and died in January 1556 falling from the staircase of the Sher Mandal inside the Purana Qila.
- Sources: Humayun-nama by Gulbadan Begum (Babur's daughter), Tazkirat-ul-Waqiat by Jauhar Aftabchi, his ewer-bearer.

Sher Shah Suri - five years, and the Mughals copied everything

Sher Shah ruled only from 1540 to 1545, but RPSC gives him more space than that suggests, because Akbar's whole administration is built on his. Learn him under three heads and you will get every question: who he was, how he governed, and what he built. The 2024 paper asked his tomb, his mosque and a 'which is NOT his' question - all three out of the same small pool.

- Original name Farid Khan, son of Hasan Khan Sur, a jagirdar of Sasaram in Bihar.
- The title 'Sher Khan' was given by Bahar Khan Lohani of Bihar, traditionally for killing a tiger.
- He beat Humayun at Chausa (1539) and Kannauj (1540) and ruled from Delhi as Sher Shah.
- He died on 22 May 1545 at the siege of Kalinjar, hit by an exploding gunpowder magazine; his son Islam Shah succeeded him.

Now the administration, which is the part actually asked. His system worked because it reached below the province, right down to the pargana, and because he paid the army centrally instead of through land assignments. Four pargana officers, one job each - learn the pairs, they come as match-the-following.

Sher Shah's pargana officials

Officer	Function
Shiqdar	Law and order, military charge of the pargana
Amin (Munsif)	Measurement and assessment of land revenue
Fotedar	Treasurer - kept the collected cash
Karkun	Clerk - kept the records, in Hindi and Persian

- Mnemonic for the four: Shiqdar Sambhale (order), Amin Aanke (assess), Fotedar Fund (treasury), Karkun Kagaz (records).
- Above the pargana stood the sarkar, under a shiqdar-i-shiqdaran (order) and a munsif-i-munsifan (revenue and civil justice).
- Land was measured with the sikandari gaz and the rope; revenue was fixed at about one-third of the average produce, payable in cash or kind.
- Every peasant got a patta (title deed) and signed a qabuliyat (deed of agreement) - the state dealt with the cultivator directly.
- The army was recruited and paid centrally, with dagh (branding of horses) and chehra (descriptive roll) - Alauddin Khalji's device, revived.
- Silver rupiya of 178 grains and the copper dam - the direct ancestor of the modern rupee; his coins carried the mint name in Devanagari as well as Persian.
- Sadak-i-Azam, the Grand Trunk Road, revived from Sonargaon in Bengal to the Indus, with sarais and shade trees; four highways in all, and the sarais doubled as dak chowkis.
- Buildings: Qila-i-Kuhna Masjid (1541) inside the Purana Qila at Delhi, Rohtasgarh fort in Bihar, and his own tomb at Sasaram - octagonal, standing in an artificial lake, architect Aliwal Khan, finished 1545.
- Malik Muhammad Jayasi wrote the Padmavat in his reign.

Sher Shah's state - the machine Akbar inherited

Land measured
sikandari gaz; 1/3 of produce

Pargana officers
Shiqdar, Amin, Fotedar, Karkun

Army paid centrally
dagh and chehra revived

Sadak-i-Azam
Sonargaon to the Indus; sarais

SHER SHAH

Patta and qabuliyat
deed and counter-deed

Sarkar above it
order and revenue heads

Coinage
rupiya 178 grains; copper dam

Buildings
Qila-i-Kuhna 1541, Sasaram tomb

ASKED IN RAS

RAS Pre 2024 took three questions from this one page - the octagonal tomb in the middle of an artificial lake is Sher Shah's, at Sasaram (Bihar); the Qila-i-Kuhna Masjid stands inside the Purana Qila, Delhi; and in the negative format, the item NOT associated with Sher Shah was the Jahangiri Mahal, which is Akbar's work inside the Agra Fort.

The battle ledger - Panipat I to Panipat III

This is the single most useful table in the chapter. RPSC asks battles three ways - straight one-liner, chronological ordering, and 'who fought whom'. Keep this one ledger in your head and all three formats collapse into the same recall. Note one detail while you read it: Hemu was actually winning Panipat II until an arrow struck his eye and the elephant-borne commander fell.

Every battle you must be able to date, 1526 to 1761

Year	Battle	Contenders	Outcome
1526	Panipat I (21 Apr)	Babur vs Ibrahim Lodi	Babur wins; Lodi dynasty and the Sultanate end
1527	Khanwa (17 Mar)	Babur vs Rana Sanga of Mewar	Babur wins; takes the title Ghazi
1528	Chanderi	Babur vs Medini Rai	Babur wins; Malwa Rajput resistance ends
1529	Ghaghra	Babur vs Afghans and Nusrat Shah of Bengal	Babur wins; the east secured
1539	Chausa	Sher Khan vs Humayun	Sher Khan wins; assumes the title Sher Shah
1540	Kannauj / Bilgram	Sher Shah vs Humayun	Humayun driven out of India for 15 years
1556	Panipat II (5 Nov)	Bairam Khan, for Akbar, vs Hemu (Hemchandra Vikramaditya)	Mughal victory; Akbar's throne secured

Year	Battle	Contenders	Outcome
1576	Haldighati (18 Jun)	Man Singh and Asaf Khan vs Maharana Pratap	Mughal field victory; Pratap escapes and fights on
1658	Dharmat (Apr)	Aurangzeb and Murad vs Dara's army	Aurangzeb wins
1658	Samugarh (May)	Aurangzeb vs Dara Shukoh	Decisive - Dara's power broken
1659	Khajwa (Jan)	Aurangzeb vs Shah Shuja	Aurangzeb wins
1659	Deorai	Aurangzeb vs Dara Shukoh	Dara's last stand; executed soon after
1739	Karnal	Nadir Shah vs Muhammad Shah	Delhi sacked; Peacock Throne and Kohinoor carried off
1761	Panipat III (14 Jan)	Ahmad Shah Abdali vs Sadashivrao Bhau	Maratha disaster; Vishwasrao killed

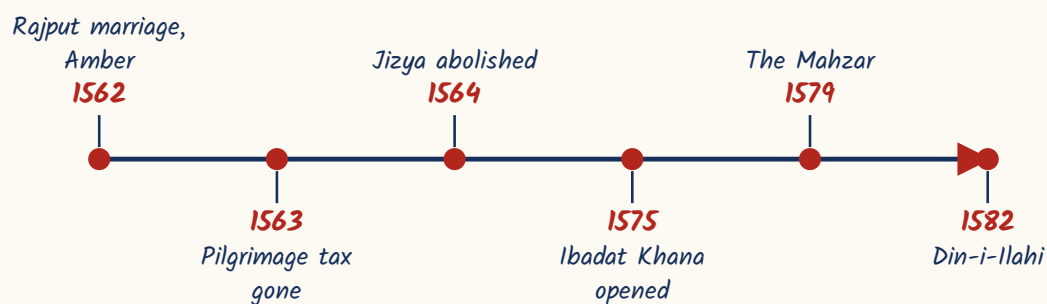
TRAP

The three Panipats are the classic mix-up. 1526 Babur vs Ibrahim Lodi. 1556 Bairam Khan (for Akbar) vs Hemu. 1761 Ahmad Shah Abdali vs the Marathas. In all three the loser's commander died on the field - Lodi, Hemu, Vishwasrao. Ordering questions in the bank: Panipat-Khanwa-Chanderi-Ghaghra for Babur, and Dharmat-Samugarh-Khajwa-Deorai for the succession war.

Akbar - Sulh-i-Kul and the religious experiment

Akbar's religious policy is asked as a chronology, not as an idea. Every step has a year, and the years run in a clean sequence: 1562 the Rajput marriage, 1563 the pilgrimage tax gone, 1564 the jizya gone, 1575 the Ibadat Khana, 1579 the Mahzar, 1582 the Din-i-Ilahi. Sulh-i-Kul, 'peace with all', is the umbrella term - it means the state takes no side between faiths.

Akbar's religious policy - one step at a time



- The Ibadat Khana was opened at Fatehpur Sikri in 1575, first to Muslim divines, then from 1578 to Hindus, Jains, Parsis, Christians and Charvakas.
- The Mahzar of 1579 made Akbar the final arbiter in disputed religious matters - it did not make him a prophet.
- Din-i-Ilahi (Tauhid-i-Ilahi), 1582, was an order of discipleship, not a religion with a scripture. Very few joined; Raja Birbal is named as the only Hindu adherent.
- Abul Fazl and Faizi, sons of Shaikh Mubarak, were the intellectual engine of the policy; Badauni, author of the Muntakhab-ut-Tawarikh, was its bitterest critic - and was still ordered to translate the Ramayana.
- Fatehpur Sikri founded 1571, in thanksgiving for the birth of Salim, near the hospice of Shaikh Salim Chishti.
- Panch Mahal - five storeys, entirely columnar, no walls, 176 pillars in all, each storey smaller than the one below; eighty-four columns on the ground floor and a four-pillar kiosk at the top.
- Buland Darwaza, 1601, commemorates the Gujarat conquest of 1572-73; the loftiest gateway in India.
- The navaratnas: Abul Fazl, Faizi, Tansen, Birbal, Raja Todar Mal, Raja Man Singh, Abdur Rahim Khan-i-Khanan, Mulla Do-Piyaza, Hakim Humam (the last two vary between lists).
- Ain-i-Akbari is the third and concluding volume of Abul Fazl's Akbarnama - the richest single source for Mughal administration, revenue rates and provincial geography.

Sanskrit works turned into Persian at Akbar's court

Original	Persian title	Translator
Mahabharata	Razmnama ('Book of War')	Naqib Khan and associates; preface by Abul Fazl
Ramayana	-	Abdul Qadir Badauni
Lilavati (Bhaskaracharya)	-	Faizi

Original	Persian title	Translator
Panchatantra	Ayar Danish	Abul Fazl

ASKED IN RAS

Asked in RAS Pre 2016 and again in 2023 - the Razmnama is the Persian translation of the Mahabharata, and the five-storeyed columnar Panch Mahal at Fatehpur Sikri was built by Akbar. In 2023 the Panch Mahal came back as a statement question on its storeys and its pillars. Two facts, three appearances, one small pool.

TRAP

Do not call Din-i-Ilahi a religion Akbar imposed on India - no book, no priesthood, no compulsion, a handful of followers. And keep the two abolitions a year apart: pilgrimage tax 1563, jizya 1564. Aurangzeb brought the jizya back in 1679, 115 years later.

Akbar's machine - mansabdari, dahsala and the offices

Understand what a mansab is before you learn any number. A mansab is a rank in one single imperial service - there is no separate civil list and military list. Every noble, whether he commands cavalry or runs a treasury, holds a mansab. The rank carries two figures, and those two figures are the whole examinable content.

Zat vs Sawar - the two numbers of a mansab

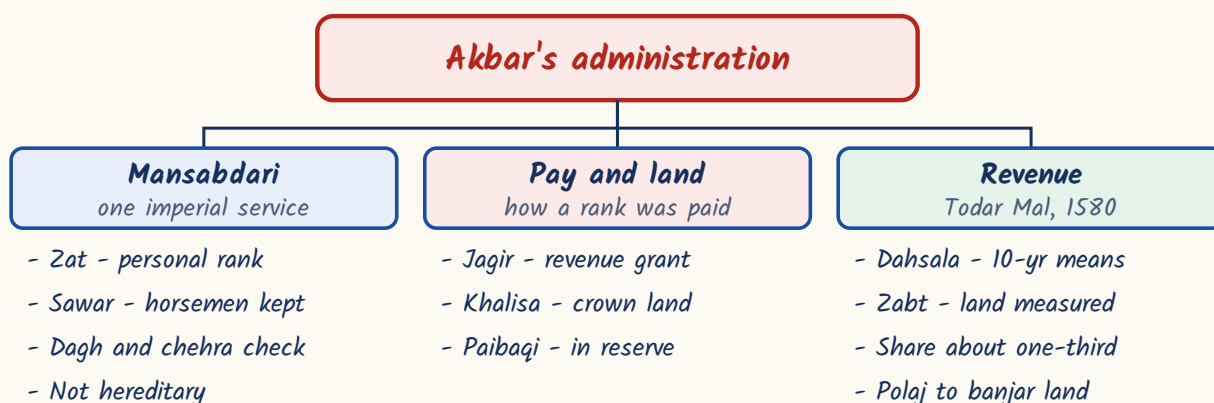
Zat	Sawar
Fixes personal rank, status and personal pay.	Fixes how many cavalymen the holder must maintain.
Decides seniority and place at court.	Decides the extra allowance paid for those horsemen.
Every mansabdar has a zat.	Sawar can never exceed zat, except in the special du-aspa sih-aspa grant.
Highest ordinary rank 5,000; princes went higher.	A noble whose sawar equalled his zat stood in the first class of his rank.

- Mansabs were neither hereditary nor permanent - on death the rank and the assignment reverted to the emperor.
- Dagh (branding of horses) and chehra (descriptive roll of the trooper) checked cheating at musters.
- Du-aspa sih-aspa - 'two-horse, three-horse' - was introduced by Jahangir, letting a favoured noble double his contingent without raising his zat.
- Ranks ran from 10 to 5,000 for nobles; Raja Man Singh of Amber held the highest mansab given to any Rajput.
- Payment was normally not in cash but by jagir - an assignment of the revenue of a tract, transferable, and never ownership of the land.
- Khalisa = crown land, its revenue going straight to the imperial treasury.
Paibagi = land held unassigned, in reserve, waiting to be given out as jagir.
- Akbar created 12 subas in 1580; the number reached 15 by the end of the reign with Berar, Khandesh and Ahmadnagar.

Now the revenue. Todar Mal's problem was that yields and prices swing every year, so a demand fixed on one year's harvest is unfair the next. His answer, the Dahsala of 1580, was to average. Take the produce and the prices of the previous ten years, average them, convert the state's share into cash per bigha, and publish the rate. The peasant then knows his demand in advance, and the state knows its income.

- *Dahsala or Ain-i-Dahsala, 1580, by Raja Todar Mal - the averages of the ten years 1570-71 to 1579-80.*
- *Also called Zabti, because it rested on measurement (zabt) of the land with the bamboo jarib.*
- *State share roughly one-third of the average produce, demanded in cash per bigha, crop by crop.*
- *Land was classed as polaj (cropped every year), parauti (fallow one year), chachar (fallow three to four years), banjar (waste over five years).*
- *The Karori experiment of 1574 was the trial run - karoris were appointed to collect a crore of dams each and to verify assessments.*

Rank, pay and land - the three parts of the system



The four Mughal revenue systems - method, not just name

System	How the demand was fixed
Zabti / Dahsala	Measurement of land plus the ten-year average of produce and prices; cash rate per bigha
Kankut	Eye estimate of the standing crop (kan = grain, kut = estimate)
Ghalla-bakhshi / Batai	Actual division of the harvested crop between state and peasant
Nasaq	Lump sum fixed from past collection figures - common in Bengal

Central and provincial officers - pure matching material

Officer	Level	Charge
Diwan-i-Ala	Centre	Revenue and finance
Mir Bakhshi	Centre	Military department - mansabs, musters, pay
Mir Saman	Centre	Imperial household and the karkhanas
Sadr-us-Sudur	Centre	Charity, grants and religious endowments
Qazi-ul-Quzat	Centre	Justice
Subedar / Sipahsalar	Suba	Governor of the province
Faujdar	Sarkar	Law and order - the armed arm of the district
Amil / Amalguzar	Pargana	Revenue collection
Kotwal	City	Policing, prices, weights, the night watch
Qanungo	Pargana	Custodian of revenue records

TRAP

The amil (amalguzar) is a revenue officer of the pargana, not a judge.

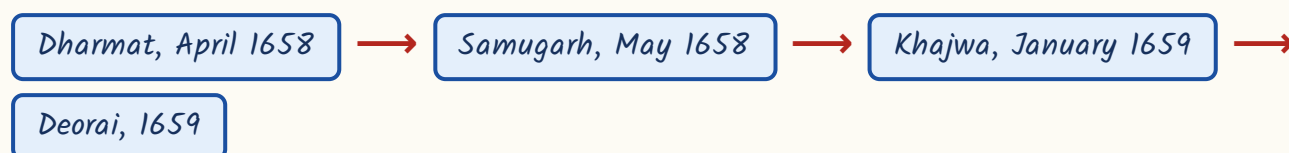
Judicial work in a province was the qazi's. The 'which pair is NOT correctly matched' question lives on exactly this slip.

Jahangir to Aurangzeb - and the fall that followed

Three reigns, and you need a small handful of facts from each. Jahangir for justice, Nur Jahan and the English envoys. Shah Jahan for buildings and the war of succession. Aurangzeb for policy reversals and the Deccan.

- Jahangir hung the zanjir-i-adl, a golden chain of justice, at Agra Fort, running from the fort wall down to the Jamuna bank.
- Nur Jahan (Mehr-un-Nisa) had coins struck in her name jointly with the emperor's, and her name entered royal farmans - unique for a Mughal queen.
- English at his court: Captain William Hawkins 1608-11, given a mansab and the title Khan; Sir Thomas Roe 1615-19, sent by James I.
- Jahangir's memoir is the Tuzuk-i-Jahangiri; the du-aspa sih-aspa rank is his.
- Shah Jahan's reign is the architectural peak - Taj Mahal, Red Fort, Jama Masjid Delhi, Moti Masjid Agra, the Peacock Throne; his chronicler was Abdul Hamid Lahori (Padshahnama).
- Shah Jahan was deposed in 1658 and kept at Agra Fort until his death in 1666.

War of succession, 1658-59 - the exam's favourite ordering question



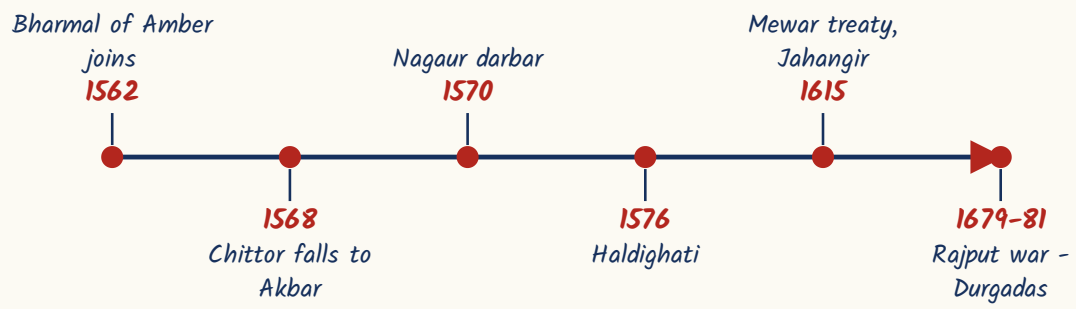
The decline that follows is not one event. The standard answer is the jagirdari crisis - too many nobles chasing too few productive jagirs. The Deccan wars added mansabdars faster than they added revenue, the reserve land ran out, assignments were made on paper that yielded nothing, and jagirdars squeezed the peasant to make up the gap between the paper figure (jama) and the actual collection (hasil).

- Four brothers in 1658: Dara Shukoh (Punjab), Shah Shuja (Bengal), Aurangzeb (Deccan), Murad Bakhsh (Gujarat). Aurangzeb crowned himself Alamgir; Dara was executed in 1659 on a charge of apostasy.
- Jizya reimposed 1679. Bijapur annexed 1686, Golconda 1687 - Bijapur FIRST, and the order is what gets asked.
- Fatawa-i-Alamgiri, a digest of Hanafi law, was compiled under his orders; he died in 1707 and lies in a plain grave at Khuldabad near Aurangabad.
- Later Mughals: Bahadur Shah I, Jahandar Shah, Farrukhsiyar (a puppet of the Sayyid brothers, the 'king makers'), Muhammad Shah 'Rangeela'.
- Farrukhsiyar's farman of 1717 gave the English Company duty-free trade in Bengal for Rs 3,000 a year - the Company's 'Magna Carta'.
- Nadir Shah beat Muhammad Shah at Karnal in 1739, sacked Delhi and took the Peacock Throne and the Kohinoor; Ahmad Shah Abdali invaded repeatedly from 1748.
- Successor states broke away: Bengal under Murshid Quli Khan, Awadh under Saadat Khan, Hyderabad under Nizam-ul-Mulk Asaf Jah in 1724.

The Rajput angle - where RPSC bends this chapter

This is a Rajasthan exam. Every Mughal reign gets re-asked from its Rajput side, and that side is also your bridge to the RH06 chapter. Read this as the same chronology told from Amber, Chittor and Jodhpur instead of from Agra.

The Mughals and the Rajputs - the dates that matter



- 1562 - Raja Bharmal of Amber is the first major Rajput chief to accept Mughal service; his daughter married Akbar, his son Bhagwant Das and grandson Man Singh rose to the very top.
- The alliance was not only matrimonial - Rajput chiefs kept their watan jagirs (homelands) and served as mansabdars elsewhere in the empire.
- 1568 - Chittor falls to Akbar; Jaimal and Patta (Fatta) die defending it, and Akbar set up their elephant-mounted statues at the Agra Fort gate.
- 1569 - Ranthambore surrenders under Surjan Hada and Kalinjar falls; 1570 - the Nagaur darbar brings in Bikaner and Jaisalmer.
- Mewar alone refused. Haldighati, 18 June 1576 - remember that the Mughal army was commanded by Raja Man Singh of Amber, with Asaf Khan. Akbar was not on the field, so this was Rajput against Rajput. Pratap escaped; Dewair in 1582 was his counter-stroke.
- 1615 - Rana Amar Singh I makes terms with Jahangir, negotiated by Prince Khurram: Mewar keeps Chittor but may not repair its fortifications, and the Rana need not attend court in person, sending his heir instead.
- Mirza Raja Jai Singh of Amber was Aurangzeb's commander against Shivaji - the Treaty of Purandar, 1665, is his work.
- 1678 - Maharaja Jaswant Singh of Marwar dies at Jamrud and Aurangzeb tries to bring Marwar under direct rule.
- 1679-81 - the Rajput war. Durgadas Rathore shields the infant Ajit Singh, Mewar's Rana Raj Singh joins the resistance, and Prince Akbar revolts against his father in 1681. Ajit Singh recovered Marwar only after Aurangzeb's death.
- Sawai Jai Singh II of Amber served the later Mughals, founded Jaipur in 1727 and built the Jantar Mantars.

Akbar's Rajput policy vs Aurangzeb's

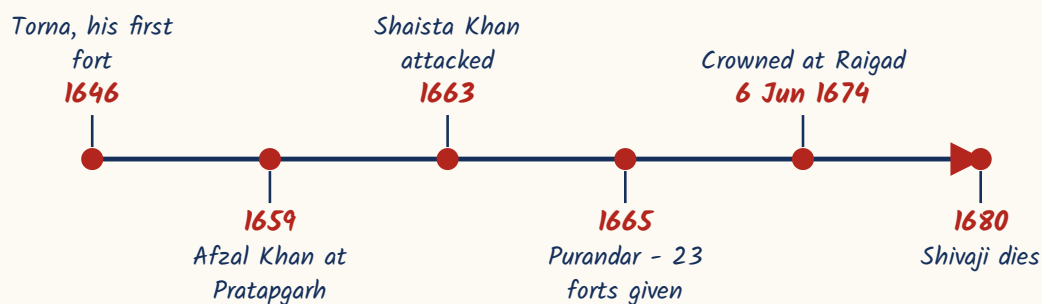
Akbar	Aurangzeb
Alliance by marriage and high mansabs; Rajputs as partners in the empire.	Suspicion and annexation; Marwar taken under imperial rule in 1679.
Pilgrimage tax and jizya abolished, 1563-64.	Jizya reimposed 1679 - a direct grievance for Rajput and Maratha chiefs alike.
Man Singh commands imperial armies from Kabul to Bengal.	Durgadas Rathore fights a long guerrilla war for Ajit Singh.
Mewar isolated, the rest of Rajputana integrated.	Marwar and Mewar in revolt together - the alliance breaks.

Shivaji and the Marathas - the power that broke the Mughals

The Marathas are examined in four blocks: Shivaji's campaigns, his administration, the Peshwas, and the wars with the English. His method was the fort and the fast light cavalry - never a set-piece battle if he could avoid one. Learn the encounters by name and date, then the council of eight, which comes as a straight match.

- Son of Shahji Bhonsle and Jijabai; guardian Dadaji Kondadev; born at Shivneri. First capture: Torna fort, 1646.
- 1659 - Afzal Khan of Bijapur killed at the foot of Pratapgarh and his army routed.
- 1663 - night attack on Shaista Khan, the Mughal governor, at Pune; he lost his fingers escaping.
- 1664 and 1670 - Surat, the richest Mughal port, sacked twice.
- 1665 - Treaty of Purandar with Mirza Raja Jai Singh: Shivaji surrendered 23 forts and kept 12. In 1666 he was taken to Agra, insulted at court, and escaped in a fruit basket.
- 6 June 1674 - crowned Chhatrapati at Raigad by the Banaras scholar Gaga Bhatt, with a new era, the Rajyabhisheka Shaka. He died in 1680.

Shivaji, fort to crown

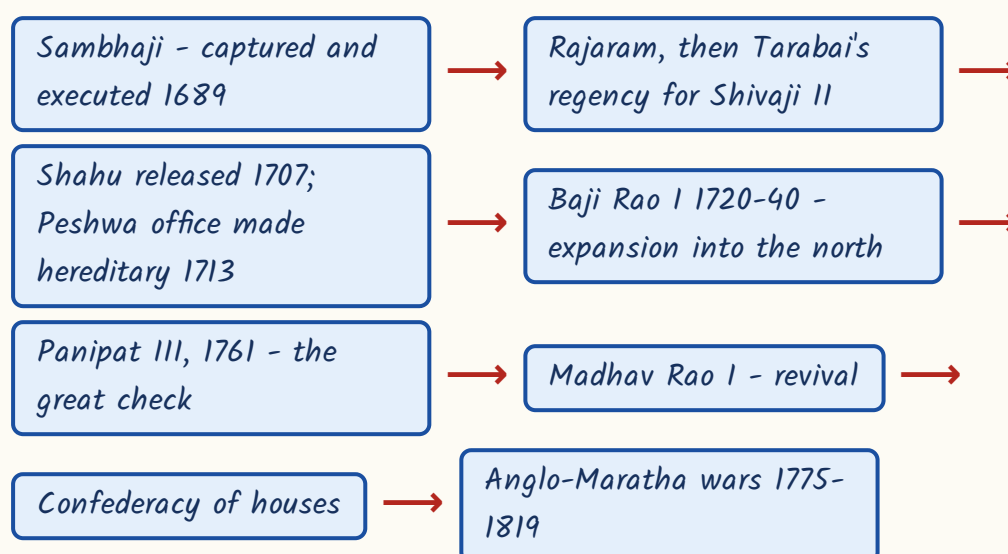


Shivaji's Ashtapradhan - the council of eight

Minister	Other name	Department
Peshwa	Mukhya Pradhan	Chief minister, general administration; first holder Moropant Trimbak Pingle
Amatya	Majumdar	Finance and revenue; audited the accounts
Sachiv	Surnavis	Royal correspondence and the checking of despatches
Mantri	Waqenavis	The king's personal records, daily journal and intelligence
Senapati	Sar-i-Naubat	Commander-in-chief of the army
Sumant	Dabir	Foreign affairs
Nyayadhish	-	Chief justice
Panditrao	Danadhyaksha	Religious affairs, charity and grants

- The Ashtapradhan was not a modern cabinet - ministers were not collectively responsible and could be posted to military command.
- Chauth = one-fourth of the assessed revenue of a territory; Sardeshmukhi = a further one-tenth, claimed as the hereditary right of the sardeshmukh.
- The two together are a protection levy, not a land tax - raised from lands outside Shivaji's own kingdom, and later from Malwa, Gujarat and the Rajput states.
- In his own swarajya, revenue was assessed on measured land at about one-third to two-fifths of the produce.
- A standing army on regular pay, and no hereditary jagirs for nobles - a deliberate rejection of the Mughal jagir model.
- Land forts (giri-durg), sea forts (jal-durg) and a navy: Raigad, Pratapgarh, Torna, Rajgad, Shivneri, Sindhudurg, Vijaydurg.

Maratha power after Shivaji



- Balaji Vishwanath, appointed Peshwa by Shahu in 1713, made the office hereditary in his Chitpavan Brahmin family and secured the Mughal grant of chauth and sardeshmukhi over the Deccan in 1719.
- Baji Rao I - the greatest of them; beat the Nizam-ul-Mulk at Palkhed (1728) and again near Bhopal (1737-38); the idea of Hindu Pad Padshahi; took Bassein from the Portuguese in 1739.
- Balaji Baji Rao (Nana Saheb) was Peshwa at Panipat III; Madhav Rao I rebuilt the power after it; Baji Rao II was the last.
- Third Battle of Panipat, 14 January 1761 - the Maratha army under Sadashivrao Bhau with artillery under Ibrahim Khan Gardi, defeated by Ahmad Shah Abdali. Vishwasrao, the Peshwa's son, was killed. The Marathas fought without Rajput, Jat or Sikh allies.
- The confederacy, house to seat: Peshwa-Poona, Gaekwad-Baroda, Holkar-Indore, Scindia-Gwalior, Bhonsle-Nagpur.
- Sambhaji was executed in 1689, not 1681 - the statement question in the bank turns on exactly that year.

Anglo-Maratha Wars

War	Years	Key treaties and battles
First	1775-82	Treaty of Surat 1775; Convention of Wadgaon 1779; ended by the Treaty of Salbai 1782
Second	1803-05	Treaty of Bassein 1802, a subsidiary alliance, triggered it; Assaye 1803
Third	1817-19	Peshwa Baji Rao II deposed in 1818 and pensioned at Bithur; Maratha power ends

ASKED IN RAS

Repeatedly examined: chauth is one-fourth and sardeshmukhi one-tenth; the 1674 coronation was performed by Gaga Bhatt; the First Anglo-Maratha War ended with Salbai, not Bassein. The 'NOT correctly matched' version usually plants the Convention of Wadgaon in 1802 instead of 1779. Keep the three straight - Wadgaon 1779 a convention, Salbai 1782 ended the First War, Bassein 1802 began the Second.

CURRENT LINK

Current link (as of September 2026): 'Maratha Military Landscapes of India' - twelve forts, eleven in Maharashtra and Gingee in Tamil Nadu, including Shivneri, Raigad, Pratapgarrh, Vijaydurg and Sindhudurg - was inscribed on the UNESCO World Heritage List on 11 July 2025 at the 47th session of the World Heritage Committee in Paris. It took India's tally to 44 sites. A fort-to-state or fort-to-Shivaji-event question from this list is very likely.

CURRENT LINK

Current link (as of September 2026): 2024 was the 350th year of Shivaji's coronation at Raigad on 6 June 1674, and the anniversary was marked through the year in Maharashtra. In the same year a wagh nakh (tiger claw) associated with Shivaji, held by the Victoria and Albert Museum in London, was brought to India on loan and put on public display at Satara from 19 July 2024. The coronation date, the place (Raigad) and the priest (Gaga Bhatt) are what a current-affairs hook of this kind is used to ask.

REVISION RECAP

1. Panipat I 1526 Babur-Ibrahim Lodi; Panipat II 1556 Bairam Khan-Hemu; Panipat III 1761 Abdali-Marathas.
2. Babur's four battles run 1526-27-28-29: Panipat, Khanwa, Chanderi, Ghaghra. The title Ghazi comes from Khanwa.

3. *Tuzuk-i-Baburi* in Chaghatai Turkish; the Persian *Baburnama* by Abdur Rahim Khan-i-Khanan.
4. Sher Shah = Farid Khan, title from Bahar Khan Lohani. Chausa 1539, Kannauj 1540, died at Kalinjar 22 May 1545.
5. Sher Shah: rupiya of 178 grains and the dam; octagonal Sasaram tomb in a lake (Aliwal Khan); Qila-i-Kuhna 1541 in the Purana Qila; Rohtasgarh; Sadak-i-Azam.
6. Sher Shah's pargana: shiqdar order, amin assessment, fotedar treasury, karkun records.
7. Humayun built Din Panah and died in 1556 off the Sher Mandal stairs; Humayun-nama by Gulbadan Begum.
8. Akbar's religious calendar: 1563 pilgrimage tax, 1564 jizya, 1575 Ibadat Khana, 1579 Mahzar, 1582 Din-i-Ilahi with Birbal the only Hindu adherent.
9. A mansab has two figures - zat is rank and personal pay, sawar is the cavalry contingent. Du-aspa sih-aspa is Jahangir's.
10. Dahsala 1580 by Todar Mal averages ten years of produce and prices, state share about one-third; the other systems are kankut, batai and nasaq.
11. Khalisa crown land, jagir salary assignment, paibaqi reserve. Twelve subas in 1580, fifteen by 1605. *Ain-i-Akbari* is volume three of the Akbarnama.
12. Centre: Diwan revenue, Mir Bakhshi military, Mir Saman household, Sadr-us-Sudur charity. Province: subedar, faujdar, amil, kotwal, qanungo.
13. Rajput arc: Amber 1562, Chittor 1568, Ranthambore 1569, Nagaur darbar 1570, Haldighati 1576 under Man Singh, Mewar treaty 1615, Rajput war 1679-81 with Durgadas Rathore.
14. Succession war order: Dharmat, Samugarh, Khajwa, Deorai. Aurangzeb = Alamgir; jizya back 1679; Bijapur 1686 then Golconda 1687; died 1707, buried at Khuldabad.
15. Decline markers: jagirdari crisis and the paibaqi shortage, Farrukhsiyar's farman 1717, Karnal 1739 and the loss of the Peacock Throne.
16. Shivaji: Pratapgarh 1659, Shaista Khan 1663, Surat 1664 and 1670, Purandar 1665, coronation at Raigad 6 June 1674 by Gaga Bhatt.
17. Ashtapradhan: Peshwa, Amatya, Sachiv, Mantri, Senapati, Sumant, Nyayadhish, Panditrao. Chauth one-fourth, sardeshmukhi one-tenth.
18. Peshwas: Balaji Vishwanath hereditary 1713, Baji Rao I (Palkhed 1728), Balaji Baji Rao at Panipat III, Baji Rao II last.
19. Confederacy: Gaekwad-Baroda, Holkar-Indore, Scindia-Gwalior, Bhonsle-Nagpur, Peshwa-Poona.
20. Anglo-Maratha: the First ends at Salbai 1782, the Second begins from Bassein 1802, the Third ends 1818-19 with the Peshwa pensioned at Bithur.